First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office:
M: 10-12, **Tu**: 9-2, **W**: 10-12, **Th**: 9-12 & 1-5, **F**: 10-12
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Monday is Pastor Jessica's Sabbath.
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Reader: Nancy Holland
Acolytes: Mykala Pryor & Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

August 4, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Guest Preacher: Doug Klette
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Monica Newton, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Eleventh Sunday After Pentecost August 4, 2024

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:
"The most beautiful people are those who have known suffering, known struggle, known loss, and have found their way out of the depths. These persons have an appreciation, a sensitivity, and an understanding of life that fills them with compassion, gentleness, and a deep loving concern. Beautiful people don't just happen." Elizabeth Kubler Ross

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

One: Within this community

All: We experience God's unconditional love

One: Within this community

All: We rejoice in the risen Christ

One: Within this community

All: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

One: Within this community

All: We join together in worship

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**
Precious God, be upon us this day in our worship and praise. Strengthen our faith in the inclusive and loving teachings of Christ and may the Holy Spirit be our guide as we pray and

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- ➔ Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- ➔ First Congregational Church of St Albans
- ➔ Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- ➔ Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- ➔ Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- ➔ Congregational Church of So. Hero
- ➔ Our local Girl Scout Troop
- ➔ As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative.

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- ➢ F/GI Community Action
- ➢ Voices Against Violence
- ➢ Samaritan House
- ➢ Restorative Justice Center
- ➢ Pathways
- ➢ Reach-Up
- ➢ Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

discern our gathering as your church to be the Disciples of God's Realm in the world today. We pray this in the name of Jesus Christ. Amen.

Hymn*

"I Come to The Garden Alone" (1,2,3) NCH 237

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**

Righteous God, you have created us in your image to reflect your holiness. You have affirmed the goodness within us. We struggle to be the people you call us to be. You have given us the guidance of the law and the wisdom of the prophets and the gift of your presence. Still, we struggle against the pull to go our own direction without your counsel. We fail to extend the grace and compassion you give to us. Be merciful in your judgment while holding us accountable for your justice as we strive to live the fullness of life in you. Amen.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Special Music

Somewhere L. Bernstein

Scripture Reading

Luke 15:11-24

Morning Reflection

Rainbows of Hope

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn* ***"Go Now in Peace"***

Go now in peace, never be afraid
God will be with you each hour of every day

Go now in faith, steadfast, strong and true
Know he will guide you in all you do.

Go now in love, and show you believe
Reach out to others so all the world can see

God will be there, watching from above
Go now in peace, in faith, and in love.

Amen. (X3)

Benediction

Postlude *Toccata in f* S. Conrady

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ Thank You Doug Klette for being the guest Preacher this week.

July 29 - August 17
Pastor Jessica's Vacation - Rev. Preston Fuller will be providing emergency pastoral care

Breakfast Club
August 10 @9am St. Albans Diner
RSVP Sue Brown: (802)527-6336

Online Giving:

Wi-Fi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123

